

Ronald Giles

Chicago, IL (Available to relocate nationwide) | 312-523-3377 | rtgiles826@gmail.com | www.linkedin.com/in/ronaldgiles

Strategic Project Management | Experienced Program Leader | PMI - Agile Certified

About Me: Accomplished, passionate, and highly organized global project and program leader with over 20 years of experience leading projects and initiatives. I have a successful track record of owning projects from cradle to grave, delivering them on time, under budget, and with high stakeholder satisfaction. I am PMI - Agile Certified and skilled in applying both Agile and waterfall methodologies to drive complex projects from concept through completion.

Highlights of Accomplishments

- **Drove a 20% reduction in project delivery timelines** for offshore mobile application development by designing and implementing a new project control and tracking system within Jira, leading to an average of \$42K in additional savings.
- **Reduced development costs by 33%** by owning and managing a successful migration to a progressive web application (PWA), resulting in a seamless cutover with no downtime, while increasing application speed, responsiveness, and user experience.
- **Led a large-scale application migration project (from Heroku to AWS)**, achieving completion 30% ahead of schedule and a 25% cost reduction.
- **Drove a 10% increase in operational efficiency** for a \$5B+ public utility by leading and executing a \$75M project that transitioned the client from a legacy ERP system to new SaaS solutions (ServiceNow & SAP), delivered both on time and under budget.
- **Achieved 27% cost savings** for a global media and entertainment brand by managing a comprehensive cloud data migration project (moving from on-prem to cloud-based hosting).
- **Spearheaded the design, launch, and management of new, comprehensive KPI reporting and insight dashboards**, detailing critical status, risk, progress, budget, and timeline details for all live PMO client engagements.
- **Led the end-to-end development of the LYC Pledge mobile app**, overseeing the entire project lifecycle from concept to release, and ensuring on-time and within-budget delivery.
- **Led the development of a charter school application**, creating business plans, funding strategies, and academic programs to establish a strong educational foundation, and **secured \$1.3M in funding commitments** from donors.
- **Managed startup budgets totaling \$4.5M**, effectively allocating resources to support new school openings and operational sustainability and **secured \$1M in private funding** through strategic grant applications.

Core Competencies

- **Project Management & Leadership:** Project Lifecycle Management, Program Management, Software Implementation, Vendor Management, Budgeting & Cost Control, Risk Management, Cross-Functional Team Leadership.
- **Technology & Tools:** Jira\Confluence, MS Project, Smartsheets, SAP, PowerBI, SQL, AWS, Microsoft Azure, Google Cloud, MongoDB, Zendesk. MS Office Suite, MS Project

Professional Experience

Project Leader - Delivery | LYC Products Co. | Jan 2024 – Present

- Drove a 20% reduction in project delivery timelines for offshore mobile application development processes via designing and implementing a new project control, tracking, and blocker escalation process and system (within JIRA), leading to an average \$42k in additional savings.
- Reduced development costs by 33%, via owning, project-managing, and successfully completing migration to a progressive web application (PWA) leading to a seamless cutover with no down-time, while increasing application speed, responsiveness, and overall user-experience.
- Owned and managed project to optimize platform technology-stack, ensuring mission-critical applications were leveraged and cost-optimized, while duplicative tools were deprecated, leading to a more efficient, cost-effective, and responsive application.
- Developed pilot project and led engineering team in the integration of a web-based AI chatbot into application.
- Led and managed application migration project (converting from Heroku to AWS), achieving completion 30% ahead of schedule, 25% cost reduction, and resulting in significantly improved application performance (with minimal downtime).

LYC is a startup focused on offering a purpose-driven Mobile first platform designed to support communities in fostering personal growth, community engagement, and driving positive social impact initiatives. My primary responsibilities include owning, managing, and executing software development projects. I am also responsible for managing a broad array of project stakeholders and team members, analyzing and driving process improvements and optimization, and delivering desired business outcomes on-time and under budget.

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Team Lead, Program & Project Management - Technology | Accenture | Mar 2022 – Dec 2023

- Led a \$75M PMO program for a utility company, coordinating over 250 team members to transition from a legacy system to a new SaaS integrated solution utilizing ServiceNow and SAP.
- Spearheaded cloud migration projects with AWS and Snowflake to support the global data curation team's dynamic pricing application for a Fortune 100 company's international theme parks. Facilitated the Agile Scrum teams for data migration and engineering, increasing team timeliness by 20%. Supported team's integration of a web-based chatbot into pricing application enhancing customer interactions.
- Collaborated with the security team in developing and implementing robust security strategies for operational assets, distribution versus power generation, and maintenance within the utility industry; mitigated risks, protected sensitive information, and enhanced operational efficiencies.
- Managed Power BI dashboards for program reporting, improving transparency, and empowering stakeholders with actionable insights for informed decision-making.
- Improved stakeholder communication through Power BI dashboards and real-time reporting, supporting informed decision-making.
- Coordinated the creation of Jira and Power BI dashboards for PMO and project reporting to key stakeholders and project leads; created and presented PowerPoints and leveraged Microsoft Teams to facilitate effective communications.

Accenture is a global professional services firm specializing in IT, consulting, and operations, serving clients in 120 countries. My primary responsibilities included managing and supporting design, strategy development, and end-to-end execution of technology projects for a variety of clients including those in the media & entertainment and public utility industries.

Project Leader - Application Delivery | LYC Products Co. | Feb 2018 – Mar 2022

- Collaborated with marketing leadership as a key stakeholder to define project objectives and develop a digital strategy plan aimed at achieving a 15% increase in user acquisition within the next quarter and securing 3 strategic organizational partnerships by year-end to support app growth.
- Managed the ongoing maintenance and updates of the company website using WordPress, ensuring adherence to defined scope and achieving 99.9% website uptime and a median content update turnaround time of 2 business days, contributing to continuous brand engagement and content delivery.
- Managed all stages of the software development lifecycle for the LYC Pledge mobile app, from initial planning through implementation and ongoing management of the underlying technology stack. The project leveraged Zendesk, MongoDB, AWS cloud storage, OneSignal, Forest Admin, and analytics tools from Google and Apple to achieve a successful launch. Supported teams which included UI/UX designers, coders and engineers.
- Architected and integrated comprehensive technology stack leveraging SaaS platforms such as Zendesk for customer support, alongside MongoDB for data management, AWS Cloud storage for scalability, and analytics tools from Google and Apple for performance monitoring, thereby optimizing the app's functionality and overall performance.
- Collaborated with marketing leadership to define project objectives and develop a digital strategy plan aimed at a 15% increase in user acquisition.

Previous Positions

- **Program Manager, Co-Founder** | DEVSMITH | Jan 2017 – Dec 2018
- **Chief Project & Program Manager** | Connected Futures Academy | Mar 2014 – Jul 2016
- **Program Manager, Director** | Youth Connection Charter School | Jul 2007 – Mar 2013

Education & Certifications

- **Northwestern University** | Certificate for Full Stack Development | 2018
- **University of Illinois at Chicago** | Chemistry (Course Work)
- **Certifications:**
 - PMI - Agile Certified Practitioner
 - AWS Cloud Practitioner Certification
 - Microsoft Azure Fundamentals
 - Google Cloud Digital Leader Certification